

ANANYA PRADHAN

Centre for Informal Sector and Labour Studies (CISLS), School of Social Sciences

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PROFILE

Development Economist and Quantitative Researcher with postgraduate degree from JNU and over 3 years of cumulative experience in quantitative research design, primary CAPI data collection (SurveyCTO, KoBoToolbox), and automated Stata data-quality pipelines (HFCs). Working in analysis of government social security schemes, digital welfare initiatives, and Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT) programs for unorganised and informal sector workers. Proven track record in assessing Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI), state cash transfer delivery, and women's economic empowerment. Experienced in leading multi-state field operations, enumerator training, and statistical microdata analysis (Stata, PLFS microdata). Native Odia speaker with full professional proficiency in Hindi and English. UGC-NET qualified (Economics). Completing J-PAL/MITx training in Randomized Impact Evaluation.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Informal sector, Social Security Schemes & Unorganised Labour • Digital Welfare Initiatives, AI-use in Schemes & Direct Benefit Transfers (DBT, MGNREGA, PDS, e-Shram) • Gender Economics & Women's Economic Empowerment • Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI) & Social Protection Floors • Randomised Impact Evaluation • Evidence-Based Development Policy

M.A. THESIS

Gender-Based Wage Discrimination in India: An Oaxaca-Blinder Decomposition Analysis

M.A. Labour & Development Studies, JNU (2019)

Employed the Oaxaca-Blinder decomposition technique on Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) microdata to quantify the explained and unexplained components of the gender wage gap in India across formal and informal sectors. Analysis controlled for human capital endowments, sector of employment, and occupational category, contributing to the understanding of structural discrimination in India's labour markets.

FIELD AND RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Associate

Mar 2026 – Present

V.V. Giri National Labour Institute (NOIDA) — Ministry of Labour and Employment, Government of India

Project: Shaping the Future of Labour in BRICS: The Role of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Emerging Technologies

- Supporting primary and secondary data collection for a national-level policy research study including survey instrument design with gender-disaggregated modules, data cleaning, and statistical analysis in Stata
- Coordinated the organization and technical proceedings of the Final Meeting of the BRICS Labour Research Network (under the Indian Presidency), assisting with presentations and country reports for the joint study 'Shaping the Future of Labour in BRICS: The Role of Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Emerging Technologies'
- Coordinating with field teams and institutional stakeholders for data acquisition, quality assurance, and timely deliverables across multiple states
- Contributing to research documentation including data codebooks, variable descriptions, and analytical reports for policy dissemination to the Ministry of Labour
- Managing project correspondence and facilitating coordination between the research team and external government partners

Field Investigator

Jan 2026 – Mar 2026

ICSSR-Sponsored Research Project, Christ University, Ghaziabad

Project: Sustainability of Digital Jobs – Assessing Youth Livelihood Opportunities in Uttar Pradesh

- Administered structured digital surveys using KoBoToolbox across multiple geographically dispersed field sites in Uttar Pradesh managing data capture for 155+ respondents including gender-disaggregated data on digital access and employment outcomes
- Conducted real-time data quality monitoring, flagging inconsistencies and coordinating corrections with the research team
- Managed field logistics across dispersed sites while maintaining strict adherence to research protocols, ethical guidelines, and informed consent procedures

Field Investigator / Research Assistant

Nov 2024 – Jan 2025

Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi

Project: Mixed-methods study on platform-based labour and gender in Delhi NCR

- Designed and pilot-tested survey instruments with built-in validation checks, skip logic, and constraints to ensure data accuracy and consistency at point of entry
- Collaborated on a mixed-methods research study on platform-based labour including analysis of gendered labour market access and precarity
- Collected 60 primary responses using structured interview schedules across diverse field settings
- Assisted in data coding, entry, cleaning, and preliminary quantitative analysis
- Maintained detailed field documentation and respondent logs

Research Support – Rural Communities Documentation

Oct 2018 – Dec 2019

CIVICUS (via Video Volunteers), Odisha

- Translated and documented field data from Odia and Bengali to English for a community media and advocacy organisation focused on rural India
- Supported research documentation on marginalised farming, fishing, and women's Self-Help Group communities in Odisha, contributing to reports on rural livelihoods, food security, women's collective agency, and social exclusion
- Coordinated with local community correspondents for accurate representation of field realities and women's voices in policy documentation

Field Research – Self-Help Groups and Agricultural Livelihoods

Mar – Apr 2016

Kendrapara District, Odisha

- Conducted Focus Group Discussions with women's Self-Help Groups (SHGs) engaged in agriculture, fisheries, and allied rural livelihoods
- Collected quantitative and qualitative data on financial inclusion, bank linkage programmes, and agricultural credit access among rural women
- Coordinated with local block-level officials and community leaders for respondent identification and community mobilisation

Field Researcher – Rural and Tribal Livelihoods

Oct 2018 – Dec 2018

Kalahandi District, Odisha

- Conducted semi-structured interviews and participatory data collection with tribal farming communities and industrial workers in rural Kalahandi, Odisha
- Engaged with Dongaria Kondh communities in the Niyamgiri Hills, documenting livelihoods, land-use patterns, agricultural practices, and women's roles in household production
- Navigated challenging field conditions including remote locations, limited connectivity, and multilingual respondent groups (Odia/Kui)
- Managed comprehensive field documentation including interview transcripts, observation notes, and photographic records

Survey Training and Field Data Collection

Sept 2018

Society for Social and Economic Research (SSER), Delhi

- Completed structured training in survey methodology, sampling techniques, and field data collection protocols for informal sector research
- Conducted interviews with industrial, migrant, and agricultural labourers applying trained survey administration techniques

Field Research – Informal Urban Workers

Feb – Mar 2018

Munirka, New Delhi

- Conducted 35 structured interviews with informal sector workers including mess workers, security guards, and street vendors
- Contributed to research documentation on labour conditions and worker welfare with attention to gender and caste dimensions

Field Research – Caste and Rural Informal Labour

2016

Khamarsahi Village, Kendrapara District, Odisha

- Conducted interviews with Scheduled Caste informal workers in a rural agricultural setting
- Documented caste-based discrimination patterns in informal rural employment and agricultural labour with attention to intersections of gender and caste

EDUCATION

M.A. – Labour and Development Studies

2019

Centre for Informal Sector and Labour Studies (CISLS), JNU, New Delhi | Grade: 6.25/9

Relevant Coursework: Research Methods, Development Economics, Rural Labour Markets, Statistical Analysis

Thesis: Gender-based wage discrimination in India – an Oaxaca-Blinder decomposition analysis using PLFS data

M.A. – Analytical and Applied Economics

2017

Utkal University, Bhubaneswar | Grade: 65.67%

Relevant Coursework: Econometrics, Agricultural Economics, Environmental Economics, Mathematical Economics

B.A. – Economics

2014

Utkal University, Bhubaneswar

ADDITIONAL QUALIFICATIONS

- UGC-NET Qualified (Economics) — covers Agricultural Economics, Environmental Economics, Development Economics, Indian Economy, Quantitative Methods
- PG Diploma in Computer Applications

TECHNICAL AND SOFTWARE SKILLS

Statistical Analysis and Data Management

- **Stata (Primary):** Data cleaning and management (.do file scripting), Stata high-frequency checks (HFCs), continuous data quality monitoring, variable construction, merge/append operations, descriptive statistics, cross-tabulations, OLS regression, Oaxaca-Blinder decomposition, PLFS microdata analysis, reproducible code with version-controlled .do files
- **R:** Data wrangling (dplyr, tidyr), regression analysis, data visualisation (ggplot2), basic spatial data handling
- **Python:** PLFS microdata analysis (pandas, numpy), web scraping (BeautifulSoup), data visualisation (matplotlib, seaborn), data cleaning, and statistical summaries
- **MS Excel (Advanced):** Pivot tables, VLOOKUP/INDEX-MATCH, conditional formatting, data validation, large dataset cleaning, summary dashboards

Survey Design and Digital Data Collection

- **SurveyCTO:** Hands-on experience with survey form programming using XLSForm, skip logic, constraint validation, data encryption, audit trail configuration, and server-based data monitoring
- **KoBoToolbox / ODK:** Form design using XLSForm, skip logic and relevance conditions, constraint validation, cascading selects, repeat groups, GPS point capture, offline data collection, server-based data monitoring
- **Survey Methodology & Field Operations:** Field team supervision, enumerator training protocols, questionnaire design, pilot testing, sampling frame development, informed consent procedures, real-time data quality monitoring

Geospatial and Mapping Tools

- GPS data collection via mobile survey tools (KoBoToolbox geopoint/geotrace)
- QGIS (actively learning): spatial data visualisation, shapefile handling, thematic map preparation, map composition
- Google Earth Pro: site mapping, spatial referencing, and distance/area measurement

Documentation and Reproducibility

- LaTeX: basic document preparation and formatting
- Research documentation: field protocols, data architecture records, codebooks, sampling frameworks, README files
- Version control awareness (Git basics)
- Data Visualisation: Datawrapper (interactive charts, maps), Canva (infographics, presentation-ready graphics)

LANGUAGES

- **Odia:** Native (speak, read, write) — full professional proficiency
- **English:** Bilingual — academic writing and professional communication
- **Hindi:** Professional working proficiency
- **Bengali:** Read and speak

RELEVANT TRAINING

- **Designing and Running Randomized Evaluations** — J-PAL/MITx (in progress)
- **Data Analysis for Social Scientists** — MITx (in progress)
- Survey methodology, sampling techniques, and field protocols — SSER, Delhi (2018)
- Digital survey tools — KoBoToolbox and SurveyCTO: instrument design, XLSForm programming, deployment, and real-time monitoring
- Qualtrics(Learning), Qualcoder(Beginner)
- Quantitative research methods: Econometrics, Applied Statistics (M.A. coursework, Utkal University and JNU)
- UGC-NET Economics syllabus including Agricultural Economics, Environmental Economics, Indian Economy, and Quantitative Methods